South Marston Parish Council

SMPC response to S/COND/22/1257: CADC-2

The CADC (Page 8/9) states it should not cover site assessment, junctions/crossings, and service utilities. We believe that it should reference these factors where they have not been addressed in precursor planning documents to ensure that the CADC-2 proposal can be implemented and do not preclude satisfactory delivery of these aspects of the overall development

Compliance listing: page 10 indicates compliance of the content of the CADC with the requirements of the relevant planning condition. **We don't agree** with its conclusions since:

- We were told by the LLFA and Brookbanks prior to approval of the Surface Water Strategy that our outstanding comments re SUDS (Manor Park/Bellway drain and Thornhill ditch/surface water flow) WOULD be covered in later reserved matters. Crucial aspects of design were promised ahead of the R1). R1 has no SUDS features at all to cope with acknowledged surface water flow west to east and adding them would influence the design and layout.
- It is also not compliant with the Neighbourhood Plan, Illustrative Masterplan developed at outline stage and repeated within the Strategic Design Code because the proposals for R1 make no allowance for road connectivity to neighbouring land parcels. See annex for more detailed evidence on this.

Constraints: page 19 : no mention of key factors constraining design:

- Road connectivity with third party parcels to the west, north and east as enshrined in the Illustrative Masterplan and in the Strategic Design Code
- Impact on existing residents of South Marston Farm and Manor Farm ie their retention of means of vehicle access, access to utilities. Also, consideration of impact of construction/road closures and noise affecting them.
- Additional SUDs requirements as noted above.

Aspects which deserve more attention in the CADC-2

Road Junctions

- **The junction of the Primary Street, Morses Lane and the last section of the secondary road serving R1** is complex. Multiple roads, bridleways, footways and cycleways converge in a constricted area. The design of this area has been 'fudged' in the detailed application for the Primary Street currently submitted as it excludes mention of the new secondary road and its roadside cycleway.

  The new horse route in dotted brown from the Leaze to the Primary Street is presumably to connect with Morses Lane and the Keypoint bridleway. The link at Morses Lane is not shown (neither is any footpath link) so the network is incomplete (see Mandatory Coding

Plan page 37). South Marston Farm residents have noted that their footpath access to Oxleaze Wood has disappeared and needs to be reinstated.

There is no overarching detailed plan for the whole junction (including lighting /signage/ priorities etc). Which Reserved Matter will cover this? Acknowledgement in the CADC-2 that this is a requirement would be helpful.

At present the only road access to most Manor Farm dwellings is eastward along the Leaze to Old Vicarage Lane. This is to be resurfaced and the section to the east of the secondary street will play a significant part in the overall pedestrian/cycle networks. In the future, it will be inappropriate for this stretch of single track cycleway/bridleway/footpath to still be carrying cars, HGVs, refuse and delivery vehicles. This document should ensure that there is room for the junction of the secondary street with the Leaze to have adequate left and right turning capability to give adequate access for the Manor Farm dwellings onto the new road networks.

Strategic Utilities Infrastructure

We have been asking for strategic work to be done on delivering utilities to the new housing parcels and to connect up existing neighbouring properties. We are aware that some progress is finally being made with neighbour groups which is looking positive. We repeat that reviewing how best to connect up neighbouring properties to all utility services is required before Reserved Matters can be approved. We refer to SM Neighbourhood Plan Policy as follows:

> ***NP POLICY 12 - UTILITIES*** *Development proposals for individual parcels of land shall be accompanied by an assessment of potential for utilities connection to existing dwellings that lie within the development parcel or adjacent to it, where no connection currently exists to mains drainage or where current utility connection will be affected. Prior to the grant of reserved matters approval(s), applicants will be required, where practical, to offer to facilitate such connections at reasonable cost.*

In addition, we ask that all overhead wiring of telephone and electricity is undergrounded across the development.

The justification for complete undergrounding is that most of the existing overground wiring crosses through multiple housing parcels, where it will be undergrounded, leaving ugly sections of overgrounding in the green open space in between. We note that utilities services are most likely to be buried under cycleways and footways that criss-cross the green open space, which offers opportunities for undergrounding across the development.

Review of remaining CADC-2 content:

- **The Access and Movement Strategy p26 r**epeats the CADC-1 'crime' by refusing to acknowledge Swindon and Keypoint as being 'key destinations' for cycling.

  Secondly, although it includes routes to the 'Village Centre', there is no specific mention of access to the expanded school. The footpaths to the play area or sports pitches will only be completed at 370 dwellings (Movement Sequencing page 28). but

this still fails to get primary school children to the school until the whole Village Centre is delivered.

R1 would have a convoluted access to the Leaze to take advantage of new routes secured through Magdalene Close. The provision of cycleways for R1 through the Bell Gardens Field is the eventual route, but the timing of development of this is unspecified (it would be determined by the build of the new Hall and car park at a much later date).

How can a more direct, safe pedestrian/cycle access to school for R1 be achieved ahead of the overall build of the Village Centre being completed?

- **Walking and Cycling (p36)** – states 'new footpaths will run alongside the parcel edges….' which may not be the best solution to enabling good design of the parcels or aid the pedestrian/cycle access to neighbouring open space. We would prefer a more general statement that that footpath/cycle provision between parcels and neighbouring open space should be designed as part of the detailed design stage.

  As an example - a footpath link from R1 should be made through the hedgerow into Oxleaze Wood. This fits with the development plans for the SBC-owned Oxleaze Wood which is not as well used as it could be since it has a single entrance from Morses Lane and a single circular path within it. An appropriate access from the north could potentially be provided via the R1 LEAP area within the adjacent open space south of Thornhill, rather than providing further restriction on housing layout on the southern boundary of R1. It just needs a mention within the Coding Plan.

- **Tertiary Roads p32 -** all defined as shared surface. This is too prescriptive in the light of the need to accommodate the potential road links to Thornhill Rd, Thornhill Industrial Estate and Manor Farmyard.
- **Built Form Framework page 50.** We are concerned that the 'mandatory coding plan' should be based on a road network that reflects the relevant constraints – in the case of Vistry R1, the layout needs to accommodate the potential new road links east, west and north.
- **Building Heights Page 52 and page 60** – our SM Neighbourhood Plan limits housing higher than 2 storeys to landmark locations only – The reference in the CADC talks about 'carefully considered locations' which is not the same thing and overuse will be resisted!
- '**Consistent roofscape'** – Our preference is to reflect a more rural style of varying roofscapes throughout – we note that the CADC-2 proposes this on what are being called the 'rural edges'. It is worth noting that the South Marston Neighbourhood Plan is aiming for the expansion of South Marston to have a 'rural feel'. We do not object to short runs of terraced housing, but would prefer variety of roofscapes elsewhere within housing parcels.
- **Estate railing mentioned** – we approve – we do not want wooden fencing to be used other than other than to separate rear garden plots.

Annex: CADC-2 is not compliant with South Marston Neighbourhood Plan Policy NP1, the approved Illustrative masterplan from the outline permission, nor the approved Strategic Design Code

When South Marston Parish Council prepared its Neighbourhood Plan from 2012 onwards, we attempted to avoid piecemeal development that would fail to create a cohesive, integrated village as it underwent expansion. Policy NP1 and accompanying text states:

> ***NP POLICY 1 – INTEGRATED DEVELOPMENT*** *Development at South Marston Village will deliver a coherent village structure based around a central village area with strong connectivity achieved through its network of streets, cycleways and footpaths. All developments will be built to a common set of design principles as outlined in the Local Plan and expanded upon in this Neighbourhood Plan.*
>
> 14.2. Development must adhere to a coherent plan to ensure the delivery of community facilities essential to serve the expanded community which includes the existing housing, potential brownfield development, windfall sites and the strategic allocation under the New Eastern Villages proposals. A piecemeal approach would lead to inappropriate layouts, densities and design on individual sites that would be contrary to the comprehensive approach required by Local Plan Policies RA3, SD1 and DE1.
>
> 14.3. As development areas are likely to be developed separately, a co-operative design approach must be followed, especially where areas are adjacent, in order to maximise the opportunity for connectivity in the network of streets, cycle and footways in line with the Policies in this Neighbourhood Plan.
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> 14.4. A well planned network of streets, cycle and footways in accordance with the Manual for Streets' principles will encourage villagers to access a well-designed Village Centre in line with Local Plan Policy RA3.

We sought and got assurances from representatives of all known developers at the time, including HHT, that they would work towards delivering maximum connectivity with neighbouring parcels of land. In respect of South Marston Phase 2, this meant ensuring that was now known as the Vistry parcel R1 would enable potential road links with:

- to the west, to have access through to Thornhill Road, to connect with developable land bordering Thornhill Rd
- to the east through to the largely redundant Manor Farmyard which would otherwise be quarantined from development, so housing development there could progress in due course.
- To the north through to Thornhill Industrial Estate for, at a minimum, footpath/cycleway access – the Neighbourhood Plan supports the development for housing of current industrial uses there and the owner is open to that happening if the site can be accumulated.

This concept was agreed within the outline planning permission S/OUT/13/1555 and reproduced on the Illustrative Masterplan.

Extract from the approved 'Illustrative Masterplan' from the grant of outline permission

The Masterplan LHL005/177/F was then reproduced within the approved Strategic Design Code (p11) but with no relevant explanatory text.

The new draft **CADC-2 Mandatory Coding Plan** at page 23 reproduces the Thornhill Rd potential connection, but not the Manor Farmyard connection, nor the potential link to Thornhill Rd Industrial Estate. It does introduce a different potential link through to Manor Park to the north, but this was not specified as being necessary for the connectivity we sought, nor was it included in the Strategic Design Code.

<u>The Mandatory Coding Plan is therefore not compliant</u> with the South Marston Neighbourhood Plan Policy NP1, the Illustrative Plan attached to the outline planning permission or the approved Strategic Design Code.